East Med problems go global

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【要点】

・ギリシャがトルコとリビアの海上国境協定をめぐり、国連安全保障理事会に提訴する予定であり、EU指導部はこの協定が国際法に違反していると支持している。

・問題となっているのは2019年に署名されたトルコ・リビア間の協定で、ギリシャの島々とエジプトの海域権を無視してエネルギー資源の領有権を定めようとしている。

・ギリシャとキプロスはEUとともに、この協定は第三国の主権を侵害し海洋法に違反していると主張し、他の複数国も支持を表明している。

・ドイツの自動車メーカーが中国市場での競争激化と販売減少により経営が悪化している。

・欧州議会の政治グループが、中東向けフライトへの排出権取引制度（ETS）拡大と引き換えに業界への財政支援を増やす妥協案を検討している。

【メール原文】

Presented by BMW Group By MARTINA SAPIO with JORDYN DAHL and TOMMASO LECCA SNEAK PEEK — Greece is expected to bring the disputed Turkey-Libya sea-bord

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By MARTINA SAPIO

with JORDYN DAHL and TOMMASO LECCA

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SNEAK PEEK

— Greece is expected to bring the disputed Turkey-Libya sea-border deal to the U.N. Security Council today.

— Political groups at the European Parliament are working on a compromise to extend the ETS to flights to the Middle East, in return for greater financial support to the sector.

— The Chinese market is continuing to wreak havoc on German automakers' bottom lines as competition increases and sales contract.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

EAST MED PROBLEMS GO GLOBAL: Greece is expected to bring the disputed Turkey-Libya sea-border deal to the U.N. Security Council today, after the EU backed Athens and Nicosia against the agreement cutting across their waters and offshore natural-resource claims.

Background: Eastern Libya's parliament on Oct. 20 ratified a memorandum originally signed in 2019 by Turkey and Libya's Tripoli-based government, which would draw a maritime boundary between the two countries tied to claims over offshore oil and gas resources, while disregarding Crete and other Greek islands lying between their coasts, as well as Egypt's claimed rights in the area.

Stronger together: Within hours, European Council President António Costa and Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said the deal infringed the sovereign rights of third countries, did not comply with the Law of the Sea and was "null and void." They reaffirmed the EU's solidarity with Greece and Cyprus, and top EU diplomat Kaja Kallas also came out against the agreement.

Taking it to New York: Greece briefed the Security Council on the ratification, and on Monday it delivered a statement at the U.N. on behalf of itself, Cyprus, Egypt, Bahrain, the United Arab Emirates and the EU. The statement argued that the Libyan vote "does not alter this legal reality" and that the memorandum cannot produce legal consequences for third countries. Mitsotakis is expected to raise the issue again today, according to a Greek government official, who described the memorandum as a "sea grab."

Outside the rulebook: The Greek and EU position is that the deal falls outside the framework of the U.N. Convention on the Law of the Sea and customary international law. Turkey and Libya do not have opposite or adjacent coasts that could provide the basis for the boundary they have drawn, and the memorandum disregards the maritime entitlements of big Greek islands, including Crete. Turkey, which is not a party to UNCLOS, maintains that the 2019 agreement complies with international law.

A second EU line: Costa and von der Leyen also repeated the bloc's opposition to "any outside interference" in Libya, a message Greece has pushed during its two-year Security Council term. U.N. Secretary-General António Guterres, asked in Cairo on Monday about violations of international law involving maritime agreements, said such breaches "are unacceptable," without referring specifically to the Turkey-Libya deal.

Trouble elsewhere: Today's U.N. discussion is also expected to touch on maritime security, which is deteriorating in the Black Sea, where more than half a dozen attacks on commercial shipping in recent weeks have been linked to the Russia-Ukraine war. On Wednesday, drones struck another container ship in Bulgaria's exclusive economic zone.

EMISSIONS

LIESE EYES COMPROMISE ON AVIATION ETS EXTENSION BY BOOSTING INNOVATION SUPPORT: Peter Liese, the European Parliament's rapporteur for the Emissions Trading System revision, is working on a

compromise among political groups to extend the ETS to flights to the Middle East and North Africa, as proposed by the Commission, in return for greater financial support for innovation in the sector.

Internal talks in the EPP: Speaking Wednesday at a press briefing, Liese also acknowledged that his own group, the European People's Party, remains divided on the Commission proposal. Tommaso has more .

Recycling ETS revenues: "Airlines are formally against the new scope," Liese said. "But when you talk to them, they also understand that the existing scope is not perfect and their main interest is … to get more support [from the EU]," he added. Liese told reporters he's working on a compromise that would increase the share of ETS revenues being "recycled to the innovation in the aviation sector."

Some background: Only a small share of ETS revenues is currently reinvested in clean aviation technologies through programs such as the Innovation Fund. The Commission has also proposed increasing the number of ETS allowances reserved for airlines using sustainable aviation fuels from 20 million to 110 million.

Shipping more constructive: While talks with airlines remain tense, Liese acknowledged that the maritime sector has taken a more constructive stance. "I'm very grateful that the shipping industry doesn't challenge the scheme," he said. Liese noted that airlines have consistently opposed the ETS, both when it was introduced for flights within the European Economic Area and when the Commission proposed extending it to flights to the Middle East. By contrast, the ETS already covers 50 percent of emissions from international shipping voyages departing from or arriving at EU ports, yet the maritime sector has been less vocal in its opposition.

Maritime has concerns too: But Liese acknowledged that shipping companies "have a point" when they complain that the Commission proposal does not sufficiently address competition from non-EU ports, particularly in the Mediterranean. He pledged to take the industry's concerns into account when drafting Parliament's compromise text in the coming weeks.

A message from BMW Group: Technology diversity doesn't mean treating every technology as equally effective. It means achieving reductions through complementary solutions, without depending on a single technology or supply chain. This immersive data story explores the role of different technologies on Europe's automotive transition.

RAIL

SPAIN HIT BY ANOTHER DEADLY RAIL CRASH: At least 68 people were killed after two high-speed trains collided south of Madrid on Wednesday morning, making it deadlier than the Adamuz crash in January that killed 46 people and again putting Spain's rail safety under intense scrutiny.

What happened: A Renfe train rear-ended a stationary Iryo service near Urda in Toledo province, sending two Iryo carriages down an embankment. Both trains were traveling between Madrid and Seville, and dozens of people were injured.

Human error: Transport Minister Óscar Puente said an official at the national railway control center in Madrid had "inexplicably" instructed one train to proceed onto a track where the other had stalled. The official has been identified and is being questioned by the Civil Guard and Spain's Railway Accident Investigation Commission.

Renfe has halted high-speed ticket sales between Madrid and Andalusia through December following the crash, though services could resume earlier if infrastructure manager Adif reopens the line.

Martina has more here .

CARS

DEATH BY A THOUSAND CUTS: That's how Deutsche Bahn analyst Tim Rokossa described the situation Mercedes-Benz finds itself in in China after reporting that sales in the market dropped 31% in the third quarter this year, even as global sales increased. CEO Ola Källenius acknowledged the problems in an earnings call with investors on Wednesday, responding that the Chinese market is "deteriorating beyond what we had thought would happen this year."

Don't blame me: Mercedes cut its profit outlook the evening before the financial results, warning investors that costs in the final quarter of the year will increase thanks in part to more expensive materials. The war in Iran has increased energy and commodity prices, including on things like steel and aluminum, which are critical to vehicle production. The automaker's revenue fell 4.5% from €32.15 billion in the third quarter of 2025 to €30.7 billion this year.

Love story: China was once the cash cow for Germany's automakers, helping subsidize production and employment costs at home. Now it's dragging down sales across European automakers, including in the luxury segment that has historically been shielded more from Chinese incumbents than mass market brands like Volkswagen. That shift in competition is now undercutting Mercedes, along with a broader cutback on luxury spending in China as the economy weakens.

Untouchable: Yet that dynamic isn't changing the role China will play in the automaker's strategy, with Källenius saying "it will remain a very important part of our business." In many ways, European automakers are stuck. They must remain in China to get access to the latest technology and innovations — but the losses there will continue to reverberate across Europe.

This is why we can't have nice things: The downturn will be felt at headquarters in Germany where Mercedes is launching a second round of buyouts on Dec. 1 as part of a broader cost-cutting strategy. The company refused to specify how many jobs will be cut, but it will mirror the first round that saw 5,500 jobs culled. The cost-cutting coincides with a broader look at shifting production to cheaper locales in Eastern Europe.

Nothing new: Fellow European automaker Stellantis also reported its third-quarter earnings on Wednesday, telling investors its turnaround plan is progressing. But like Mercedes, the French-Italian-American brand is seeing increased competition from Chinese brands — except in Europe. "The region remains challenging with ongoing Chinese competition," CEO Antonio Filosa said on the call.

Out of the woods: Next up is Volkswagen this morning, which will be fielding questions on its own cost-cutting plan and Audi CEO Gernot Döllner's recent appearance alongside U.S. President Donald Trump at a campaign rally.

Is it over now? Yes, and extra points for those of you who figured out the bold words are Taylor Swift song titles.

**A message from BMW Group: Europe's automotive transition is underway, but turning investment and ambition into a successful industrial transformation will require more than targets alone. This immersive data story explores three questions: what it takes to turn investment into competitive battery production; how complementary solutions can deliver real emissions reductions, and what makes the transition practical, affordable and attractive for consumers and businesses. Europe has made

significant progress towards net zero. The next challenge is turning that progress into competitive industrial capacity, measurable emissions reductions and mobility solutions that work for households and businesses across the continent. What will it take for Europe's automotive transition to succeed? Read the immersive data here . **

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Spanish train disaster deals new blow to Sánchez's long-shot election bid
The deadly crash is undermining the prime minister's central pitch to voters that his government is competent and bettering Spaniards' everyday lives.
By Aitor Hernández-Morales, Rafael Méndez, Ángel Villarino Perez · Oct 28, 2026, 09:11 pm Europe/Brussels CET

EPP divided on expansion of aviation ETS, Parliament rapporteur says
By Tommaso Lecca · Oct 28, 2026, 01:57 pm Europe/Brussels CET

At least 68 people die in major Spanish train crash
The collision brings back memories of the January train crash in Adamuz, which killed 46 people.
By Martina Sapio · Oct 28, 2026, 11:39 am Europe/Brussels CET

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